

Synopsis For Grade 8 CRS Third Term

WEEKS	TOPICS
1	The passion - the triumphant entry
2	The Cleaning of the Temple
3	The Last Supper
4	The Betrayal and Arrest of Jesus
5	The trial of Jesus and Peter's denial
6	Midterm assessment
7	Jesus Trial Before Pilate
8	The Crucifixion of Jesus Christ
9.	The death of Jesus Christ
10	The burial of Jesus
11	EXAMINATION

Week 1

THE PASSION: THE TRIUMPHANT ENTRY INTO JERUSALEM.



(Matt.21: 1 – 11, Mark 11: 1 – 11, Luke 19: 28 -44)

Jesus started his earthly mission for three years. He was going from one place to another preaching, teaching people about the kingdom of God. During Jesus' last few days on earth, He started sending all his disciples on special missions. During the Passover festival celebration in Jerusalem, Jesus wanted to go down to Jerusalem. They came near Jerusalem, Bethphage and Bethany, at the Mount of Olives, he dispatched two of his disciples to the village opposite. He told them that they would find a colt tied to a door immediately on entering the city. He said it was to be one on which no one had ever sat, and that they should untie and bring it. He said that they should tell anyone who asked why they were doing so that, "The Lord has need of it and will send it back immediately". The disciples went and found the colt tied to a door on a street. They immediately untie it, but the passerby asked them why they were taking it. They replied as Jesus told them and they were allowed to go with it. On arrival where Jesus was, they threw their clothes on the colt for Jesus to sit on. Some people spread their clothes on the road, whilst others spread

leafy branches cut from the fields. All the people who followed him shouted ***"Hosanna! Blessed be he who comes in the name of the Lord! Blessed be the kingdom of our father David that is coming! Hosanna in the highest"***.

Although Jesus arrived late in Jerusalem, he was able to round the temple before he left with his disciples for Bethany, a village on the eastern slope of Mount Olives.

A similar passage in St Luke contains some additional information, not recorded in St Matthew, for example, Luke 19, verse 39 and 40 tell us about the intervention of some of the Pharisee in the crowd. They advised Jesus to caution his disciples. But Jesus replied, "I tell you, if these were silent, the very stones would cry out".

From these passages, we can see Jesus as the Messiah of peace, entering into Jerusalem. We can also notice how uneasy the Pharisees were as they watched how Jesus was being received. Jesus' reaction showed that his activities were predetermined.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE EVENT

1. It served as a fulfillment of prophecy, recognition of His role, and prepared the way for the events that led to His death and resurrection.
2. Jesus is the Messiah of peace and not war. Colt represents peace while horse is a symbol of war.
3. Jesus is the savior of the world because originally Hosanna means sure help or praise God who came to save.

Moral lessons

1. Praising God with all our belongings is not restricted to anybody. Both elders and youths, men and women threw their garments on the road for Jesus' ride. We should use what is considered important to honor Jesus.

2. Christians are expected to take part in celebrating Palm Sunday. It commemorates the triumphant entry of Jesus Christ. It is the symbol of peace.

3. Lastly, we can see Jesus as the Messiah of peace, entering into Jerusalem. Jesus' reaction showed that his activities were predetermined.

Evaluation

1. Why is it important for us to use what we have to honor God?
2. List two significance of the triumphant entry of Jesus into Jerusalem.
3. List two moral lessons from the triumphant entry of Jesus into Jerusalem.
4. What was the chant to Jesus by the people during his triumphant entry to Jerusalem?
5. Where did the triumphant entry of Jesus take place?
6. What kind of animal did Jesus' ride on for his triumphant entry?
7. Why were the people happy and singing in jubilation?
8. How many of his disciple did Jesus send to bring the animal for his triumphant entry?
9. what was the condition of the animal which Jesus told his disciples to bring?
10. What was the response to be given if anyone asked the disciples why they needed the colt?

Week 2

The Cleaning of The Temple

When Jesus entered the temple, there were lot of activities going on which includes buying, selling and exchange of money etc. This displeased Jesus did and he drove all the people that sold and bought out of the temple and overthrew the tables of money changers as well as the seats of those who sold doves. After he had driven them, he then said to them "it is written, my house shall be called the house of prayer, but you have made it a den of thieves"

The cleansing of the temple by Jesus was not a mechanical exercise but a spiritual one. The temple represents the house of God where God's presence stays and should be highly recognized as such.

Moral Lessons of The Cleansing of The Temple

1. The house of God is a sacred place; Christians should not desecrate it.
2. Christians should not underestimate the house of God and do illegitimate acts in it.
3. God is not happy with anyone or people who make the house of God unclean with activities displeasing to God.
4. God refers to our body as the temple of God, in the same way he demands purity and righteousness.



Evaluation

1. Why did Jesus drive the money changers out of the temple?
2. If asked to examine Jesus action of cleansing the Temple, what emotions do you think he evoked?
3. When Jesus went into the temple, what were some of the people doing?
4. What did Jesus do to the tables?
5. What did Jesus tell them that His House (The Temple) was?
6. When we go to worship service, what should we be doing?
7. What did Jesus compare them to?
8. Did Jesus approve of them selling doves in the temple?
9. Narrate the cleansing of the temple by Jesus.
10. List two moral lessons from the cleansing of the temple by Jesus.

Week 3

THE LAST SUPPER (Matt 26: 17 – 30, MK 14: 10-25)

According to the synoptic gospel of Matthew, on the first day of the unleavened bread, that is, bread without yeast, the disciples went to Jesus seek his instruction about his preferred choice of venue for holding the Passover Feast with his disciples. And Jesus said to them, *"Go into the city to a certain one and say to him, the teacher says, my time is at hand; I will keep the Passover at your house with my disciples"*. Jesus disciples followed his directives in preparing the Passover for the group. In the evening when Jesus was eating and drinking with the twelve disciples, He disclosed to them that He would be betrayed by one of them. In a quick reaction one after another they asked him, *"Is it I, Lord?"* and Jesus replied: He who has dipped his hand in the dish with me, will betray me. The son of man goes as it is written of him, but woe to that man by whom the son of man is betrayed. It would have been better for that man not to have been born." When Judas who eventually betrayed him asked Jesus, *"Is it I; Master?"* he told him that he (Judas) had said so.

While they were celebrating the Feast at the table, Jesus took the bread, blessed and broke it and gave it to the disciples and said *"Take, eat, this is my body. And he took the cup and when he had given thanks, he gave it to them saying, Drink of it all of you, for this is my blood of the covenant which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins. I tell you; I shall not drink again of this fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father's Kingdom."*

Jesus and his disciples closed the last supper with the singing of a hymn Book of the Jews. Thereafter they all went to the Mount of Olives.

Significance of the Last supper

1. The Last Supper is what we call the last meal Jesus ate with His disciples before His betrayal and arrest.

2. It was also more than Jesus' last meal; it was a Passover meal.



Evaluation

1. Narrate the story of the last supper.
2. When Jesus blessed the bread, what did he say?
3. What type of meal was Jesus sharing with his disciples?
4. How did Jesus say the person who would betray him could be identified?
5. After the Passover Meal Jesus went to _____.
6. After Jesus said one of them would betray him, the disciples responded with _____.
7. What were the two emblems Jesus used during the Last Supper?
8. How did Jesus' disciples find the house where they were to prepare the Passover meal which became known as the "Last Supper"?
9. What was the significance of the bread in the Lord's Supper?
10. Jesus' last supper was taken on the first day of _____.

WEEK 4:

THE BETRAYAL AND ARREST OF JESUS (Mark 14: 43 – 52; Matt 26: 47 – 56)

Jesus and his disciples retired to the Garden of Gethsemane in the vicinity of Mount Olives after the last supper to pray. Jesus groaned in prayer in the Garden of Gethsemane and made it known that it was unacceptable to observe that his disciples could not pray with him while his hour of betrayal and suffering drew near. He said to them, "Are you still sleeping and taking your rest? It is enough; the hour has come; the son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners. Rise, let us be going; see, my betrayer is at hand".

Shortly after, Judas Iscariot the traitor entered with a crowd to arrest Jesus. He had told the Jewish Priests and the Scribes that the one the guards should arrest and take away in the darkness of the night was the one he would identify with a kiss. Consequently, Judas went up to Jesus and said, "Master" and kissed him. Immediately, the crowd supported by the guards arrested Jesus. One of the disciples tried to defend Jesus by cutting off the ear of the servant of the high priest. Jesus frowned at the act of violence and said that the violent would die by means of violence. He later healed the soldier.

Of the manner of his arrest Jesus said to the Jews, "have you come out as against a robber with sword and clubs to capture me? Day after day I was with you in the Temple, and you did not seize me. But let the scripture be fulfilled." All the disciples of Jesus except Peter ran away to escape being associated with him. The guards and the crowd took Jesus to the home of Caiaphas the High Priest for trial.



Evaluation

1. narrate the story of Jesus arrest.
2. where did Jesus go to pray before he was arrested?
3. When Jesus was praying on the mount, what were the disciples doing?
4. Who brought the soldiers to arrest Jesus?
5. How did Judas identify Jesus to the armed men?
6. What did Peter do to one of the soldiers?
7. Who healed the soldier's ear?
8. What does that tell you about Jesus' character?
9. Why didn't Jesus and the disciples fight the soldiers?
10. What did Jesus tell the soldiers?

Week 5

THE TRIAL OF JESUS AND PETER'S DENIAL

After Jesus was arrested, he was taken to the house of Caiaphas the high priest where member of the Jewish Council (The Sanhedrin) had gathered for his trial. Peter followed Jesus at a safe distance as far as the High Priest's courtyard to see what would happen to Jesus. The chief priest and elders of the council looked for false accusations and charges to make against him in order to justify their intention to kill him.

The ruling council comprised of scribes, Pharisees, Sadducees and priests. The charges levelled against him included; Many false witnesses testified against him, but there was no evidence to support their allegations. Two false witnesses even came forward and said, "This fellow said, I am able to destroy the Temple of God and to build it in three days. Jesus did not answer the charges because they were false and malicious. The High Priest persuaded Jesus to respond to the allegation but he remained silent. The High Priest then asked Jesus if he was the Christ, the son of God. To this question, Jesus said to him, 'You have said so. But I tell you, hereafter you will see the Son of Man seated at the right hand of power and coming on the clouds of heaven'. The high Priest in a feat of anger and frustration tore his clothes immediately and asked the people if they had heard any blasphemy deserving judgment more than this one. They all agreed that he should be condemned to death. As a consequence, the people spat on his face and struck him with their fists, while some others slapped him when his eyes were covered and then asked him to identify who it was that struck him since he was a prophet.



Denial of Jesus by Peter

Meanwhile, Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard, watching the trial of Jesus. Then, one of the maids of the High Priest identified Peter as being one of the associates of Jesus the Galilean, but he denied it saying, 'I do not know what you mean'. Again, when Peter went out of the gates and a maid saw him and told bystanders, 'This man was with Jesus of Nazareth,' for the second time Peter denied it with an oath: 'I do not know this man'. Then after sometimes, the bystanders came up and said to Peter, 'certainly, you are also one of them, for your accent betrays you.' then in response to this identification, Peter began to swear with curses on himself in denial for the third time: 'I do not know the man'. And immediately the cock crowed, and Peter remembered that Jesus had told him that he, Peter would deny him three times before the cock crowed. And so, he went out and wept bitterly and was obviously sorry for himself.



Reasons for Peter's denial

1. Peter denied Jesus because he was afraid to die with Jesus.
2. He thought if he identified himself with Jesus he too would be arrested.
3. He denied Jesus because he lacked the boldness and courage of the spirit of God.
4. He denied Jesus because he had not been empowered by the holy spirit.
5. He denied Jesus because he was overconfident of himself and he relied on his physical ability and strength.

Evaluation

1. Where was Jesus taken to after he was arrested?
2. Which disciple followed Jesus at a safe distance after his arrest?
3. What were the accusations levied against Jesus?
4. When asked if he was the son of God, what was Jesus' response?
5. Describe the betrayal of Peter towards Jesus.
6. How many times did Peter deny knowing Jesus?
7. Who was the first person to question Peter about his acquaintance with Jesus?
8. Who was the second person to question Peter about his acquaintance with Jesus?

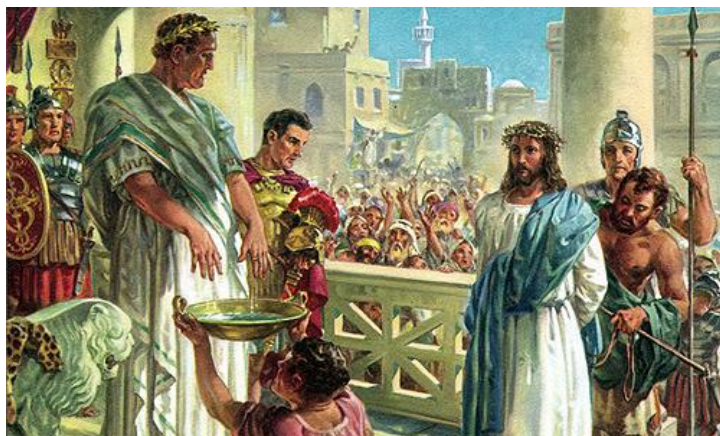
9. Who was the third person to question Peter about his acquaintance with Jesus?
10. Discuss the trial of Jesus after his arrest.

Week 7

Jesus trial before Pilate (Matthew 27:11-31)

In the morning, the council met and decided to take Jesus to be tried by Pontius Pilate, the Roman Governor of the district of Judea in Jerusalem. When they got to Pilate, he asked Jesus if he was the King of the Jews, to which Jesus replied that he had said so. The chief priest also brought up other charges against Jesus, and Pilate wanted him to respond to them; but to his greatest surprise, Jesus kept quiet.

During the Passover feast, the custom permitted Pilate the Governor of the place to exercise the prerogative of mercy, in the form of releasing one prisoner requested for by the Jews. He asked the Jews to choose between Jesus and Barabbas-a notorious prisoner who was imprisoned for sedition and insurrection against the Roman administration in the land. The people did not have a justifiable reason, but they demanded the release of Barabbas and the killing of Jesus on all the occasions that Pilate asked them. Pilate had no alternative than to obey the wishes of the Jewish crowd. He released Barabbas to them and handed over Jesus to be crucified on the cross. Having done that, the guards then led Jesus away into a special apartment in the governor's palace where they gathered the whole battalion before him. They stripped Him and then clothed him in purple dress to symbolize royalty, and on His head, they placed a crown of thorns and a stick in His right hand.



Week 8

The crucifixion (Matthew 27:32-44)

A passerby, Simon of Cyrene, was made to help carry the cross that would be used to crucify Jesus. They brought him to Golgotha (a place where people were crucified). He was offered wine mixed with myrrh, but he refused it. He was later crucified and the people divided His clothes among themselves.

The crucifixion took place at the third hour (bout 9a.m). An inscription, giving the charge against him read, 'The king of the Jews'. Two robbers were crucified with him, one on His right and the other on His left. Passers- by ridiculed Him saying, Aha! You who would destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself and come down from the cross'.

The chief priests and scribes also mocked him, saying, ' he saved others; he cannot save himself. Let the Christ, the King of Israel, come down now from the cross, that we may see and believe'. Even one of the robbers who were crucified with Him mocked him.



Evaluation

1. For whose release did the crowd request from Pilate instead of Jesus?
2. Who did the council decide to try Jesus?

3. During his trial by Pilate, how was Jesus reacting?
4. What does prerogative of mercy mean during the Passover feast?
5. Why did the Jews demand the release of Barabbas in place of Jesus?
6. Who helped Jesus to carry his cross?
7. Where was Jesus taken to?
8. What does Golgotha mean?
9. How many robbers were crucified with Jesus?
10. When did the crucifixion of Jesus Christ take place?

Week 9

The Death of Jesus (Matthew 27: 45-56)

By the sixth hour (around 12 noon), darkness came over the land and lasted till the ninth hour (3p.m). At that time, Jesus cried out aloud, ' **Eli, Eli, lama Sabathani**' which means My God why hast thou forsaken me? Some of those standing by thought he called Elijah, and one ran, filled a sponge of vinegar and gave him to drink. In fact, they wanted to see whether Elijah could come down to save him.

Later Jesus cried aloud and breathed his last. Quite unexpectedly, the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom. The centurion and those with him who watched the scene commented ' Truly, this man was the Son of God.

Five significant events followed the death of Jesus. They are:

1. There was darkness over all the land from the sixth hour to the ninth hour.
2. The curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom.
3. There was an earthquake.
4. The rocks split apart.
5. The tombs were opened and many bodies of the saints who were dead arose, went into Jerusalem and appeared to many.

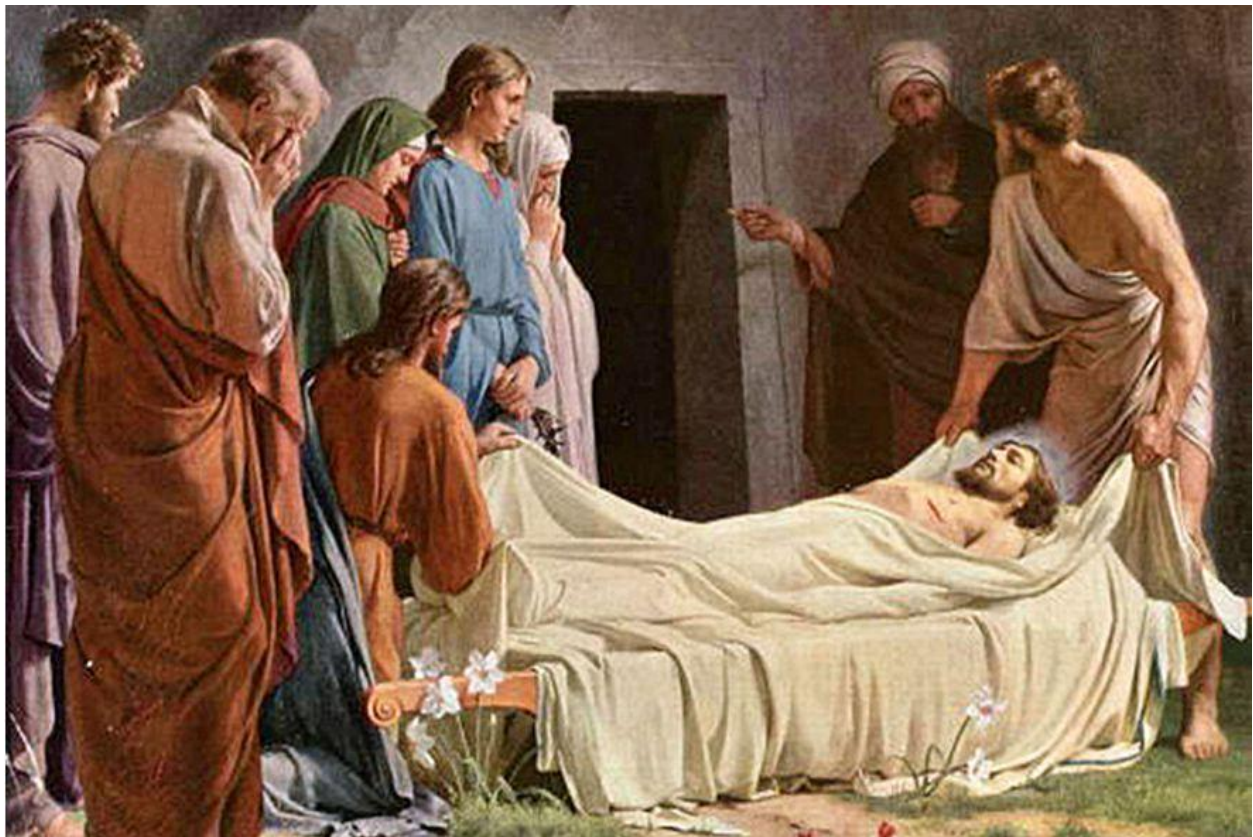
Many women, who had followed Jesus from Galilee ministering to his needs, including Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joseph, and the mother of the sons of Zebedee, stood afar, watching sorrowfully at the suffering Jesus passed through on the cross.



Week 10

The burial of Jesus Christ (Matthew 27:57-61)

In the evening of the day Jesus was crucified, Joseph of Arimathea, a member of the Council and a courageous secret disciple of Jesus, went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and laid it in his own new tomb which he had cut out of the rock. He rolled a large stone against the entrance to the tomb and then left the place for his home. Two prominent women supporters of the ministry of Jesus, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary who sat opposite the grave, witnessed the burial.



The seven statements of Jesus on the cross (Matthew 27:46; Luke 23:34-36; John 19:27-30; Mark 15:34)

1. *'Eli, Eli, lama Sabathani'* meaning, *My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?* (Matthew 27:46)

2. 'Father forgive them, for they know not what they do.' Luke 23:34
3. 'Truly I say to you, today you will be with me in paradise.' Luke 23:43.
4. 'Father, into thy hands, I commit my spirit.' Luke 23:46.
5. 'Woman, behold your son! Son, behold your mother.' John 19:27.
6. 'I thirst.' John 19:20.
7. 'It is finished.' John 19:30.

Moral lessons

1. Christians must strive to remain loyal and passionate about leaders in time of peace and in times they are facing life's troubles and challenges.
2. Christians should learn to stand firm in their faith in Jesus, and should not allow any temporary hardship to force them to backslide and take for granted Jesus' death on the cross to redeem us from sin.

Evaluation

1. Recite the seven statements of Jesus Christ on the cross.
2. What happened between the sixth- and ninth-hour during Jesus' death.
3. After Jesus breath his last breath, what happened to the curtain of the temple?
4. Name the women who watched Jesus from afar off while he was dying.
5. Which of Jesus' disciples buried him?
6. List five significant events that followed the death of Jesus.
7. State where Jesus was buried.
8. From whom did the disciple ask for Jesus body?
9. What is the significance of the sacrificial death of Jesus?
10. Describe the burial of Jesus.